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1 Introduction

Welcome to your student handbook, which explains how the university works. It is split into two sections:

1) The first covers:

- how your degree works
- the facilities and services available
- how to give feedback or report a concern
- the rules, regulations, and policies you must follow.

2) the second part includes information on your school and/or programme.

The information linked to in both parts is updated regularly. If, having read this handbook you have questions, contact [Student Connect](#) or your school.

2 Welcome to Cardiff University

We're delighted to welcome you to our community. You are now part of an ambitious and innovative university:

- founded in 1883
- bilingual in Welsh and English
- home to over 32,000 students and 7,000 staff from nearly 140 countries
- teaching more than 20 subject areas
- with 24 academic schools across three colleges.

"A warm welcome to your university - wherever you're based and whatever you're studying we have so much to offer. This handbook gives you the key information you need about studying here, the support available, and how to make the most of your university experience."

"Our student community is the heart of Cardiff University, and we welcome students from all over the world. There are many educational, social, cultural, and sporting experiences on offer to you through the university and Students' Union. To keep you updated on important news and exciting opportunities, I will write to you on a regular basis, and we hope that you enjoy your time with us."

Claire Morgan, Pro-Vice Chancellor Education and Student Experience

'As your Students' Union President, I am so excited to welcome both new and returning students to Cardiff this year! I hope this handbook will show you how to make the most of both your academic and student life during your time here.'

Maria Pollard, Students' Union President

2.1 The Student Charter

It is important you read the [Student Charter](#) and understand how it applies to you.

Created with students, the Students' Union and the university, it outlines mutual expectations and what to do if they aren't met.

2.2 Being at a Welsh university

In Wales, Welsh and English are both official languages. We hope you will embrace the Welsh language and culture while at Cardiff.

For students who are Welsh speakers there are opportunities available for you to use and enhance your Welsh language skills - academically, professionally and socially.

If you are not a Welsh speaker, there are opportunities for you to [learn Welsh for free](#) alongside your studies. Croeso i Gaerdydd / Croeso (welcome) to Cardiff!

2.3 Students' Union

[Cardiff Students' Union](#) (CSU) is at the heart of Cardiff student life. That means that CSU is here to support students to thrive and to have their backs when things don't go as planned, all within a safe, inclusive space where students can be who they want to be. CSU is consistently ranked in the top three for student satisfaction in the UK and was voted top 2 in the WhatUni Student Choice Awards for the last four years (2022-2025).

As soon as you enrol as a student, you automatically become a member of the student community at CSU. With close to 200 [societies](#), 74 [sports clubs](#) and lots of [volunteering](#) opportunities, there is plenty to get involved in. CSU also works with you in all aspects of your academic life, gives [advice](#) and support when you need it, and offers unforgettable experiences and exceptional [events](#) to help expand your community in Cardiff.

2.4 Equality, diversity, and inclusion

Find out about the support available to students, along with policies, procedures and guidance on [equality, diversity and inclusion](#).

2.5 Sustainability

Get involved in [sustainability activities](#) to help reduce our carbon footprint and add green skills to your CV.

2.6 Freedom of speech and planning events

The principles of freedom of speech, freedom of expression and academic expression are important to us as an academic institution. However, we are bound by legislation to ensure these principles are exercised in compliance with laws protecting national security and public safety, preventing disorder or crime, and protecting the legal rights of others (for example, in relation to harassment and discrimination).

[Read the code of practice](#), which outlines the procedures and conduct required of those organising or attending meetings and other activities.

If you plan to organise events held in university buildings or branded as a 'Cardiff University event' a [risk assessment](#) must be completed and returned 21 days prior to the event to:

- for university-controlled pool rooms: roombooking@cardiff.ac.uk
- for conference facilities: conference@cardiff.ac.uk
- for school-controlled rooms send the form to the appropriate individual school office which must then send the form to Compliance and Risk (complianceandrisk@cardiff.ac.uk) for final sign off.

3 Getting started

3.1 Orientation

Make sure you have completed orientation. If you have not received an email from welcome@cardiff.ac.uk for the orientation platform contact [Student Connect](#).

3.2 Registration and enrolment

You should have completed [online enrolment](#). This includes confirming your personal and study details, who pays your fees and other essential information.

If you are a home student you must complete these steps to trigger the release of your student loan (if you have applied for one).

If you did not complete online enrolment before arriving in Cardiff and need assistance, visit our [student ID card collection point](#).

3.3 Student ID card

Collection of your student ID card is a mandatory step in the [enrolment process](#) for campus-based students. As well as proof of identity, your ID card provides library and e-learning access and entry to university buildings.

It will be valid for the duration of your studies, and you must carry it with you on campus. You can also access a digital version of your ID card via our [Student App](#).

If your ID card is lost, stolen or damaged you can [request a replacement](#) at the Centre for Student Life.

If you are a distance-learning student, a student ID card is not required.

3.4 Your student record

The Student Information Management System ([SIMS](#)) is our tool for managing student records. It is the portal you use to enrol, choose modules, and pay fees, and stores your:

- personal details and contact information

- academic information
- module and programme information.

You must [keep your record up to date](#) so we have your:

- mobile telephone number
- home and term-time address
- [trusted contact information](#)
- [preferred name](#)
- changes to your programme of study/modules.

You can amend your student record or request confirmation of your student status via [SIMS](#).

We also encourage you to disclose your equality data. This helps us see where there may be differences of experience or barriers, and may be used by authorised groups to help improve the inclusivity and diversity of our services. Our equality monitoring data is reported anonymously in our [annual monitoring report](#).

Our [data protection notice](#) explains how we use your data, and how it is kept secure.

Data protection legislation gives you certain [rights](#) in relation to the information we hold about you, such as requesting a copy of the personal data we hold for you. Not all information held will be considered your personal data and you may not be entitled to receive all the information you request, such as, only being entitled to receive exam scripts where there are additional comments made by the marker (see [marking and moderation policy](#) for details). Contact the [Compliance and Risk team](#) for more information.

3.5 Payment of fees

You are required to [pay tuition fees](#), or provide evidence of sponsorship, for each year of your course (including repeat years).

If paying your tuition fees via [SIMS](#), ensure you are ready to make the payment before continuing to the fee payment stage of the task. Once you reach this step, you will be unable to save and exit, or continue without making the payment, and you will need to seek support from your school.

3.6 Academic Regulations Handbook

The [academic regulations handbook](#) explains the rules and regulations governing your programme. These are supplemented by several policies and processes that will support you through your studies.

The regulations are reviewed frequently, and students are consulted on the impact of any proposed changes to regulations. As a student enrolled on a programme with us, you agree to abide by our academic regulations, so it is important that you familiarise yourself with them

and with the range of policies and procedures that underpin them. Section 9 has further information on Academic Regulations.

3.7 Library services

Our Library staff and facilities provide resources, support and a welcoming environment to help you learn. You can study at any [library on our campuses](#), no matter what course you are studying.

You'll also have access to tools and support through our [live chat service](#). Each academic school has [subject librarians](#) who also provide support and training.

Use the [LibrarySearch](#) catalogue to find and access print and online resources and to check your library account. The [Lean Library](#) plugin gives you seamless access to resources when working away from our campuses. Visit [Welcome to the Library](#) for more information.

3.8 University IT

All students using our IT facilities are bound by the [university IT regulations](#), which are supported by the information available on the [security and scams intranet pages](#) and the [information security policies](#).

3.9 Connecting to the network

Eduroam is a fully secured, on-campus wireless network, available to students after enrolment. Find out [how to connect](#).

If you have trouble connecting, or need quick and easy access to the internet for a short time, you can use your university email address and password to connect to [CU-Wireless](#) (not available in some Cardiff and Vale Health Board locations).

The [CU-PSK network](#) allows you to connect gaming consoles and smart speakers to the Wi-Fi from university accommodation, however [not all devices and games are compatible with the network](#).

3.10 Keeping in touch – online meetings and video-calling

Keep in touch using [Microsoft Teams](#), and learn how to keep your video calls secure.

3.11 IT help and advice

Search the intranet for help to get online, stay secure, and accessing software.

3.12 Get in touch

- Access in-person [IT support](#) in the Centre for Student Life
- For urgent enquiries call us 24/7 on +44 (0)29 2251 1111 (some requests may not be resolvable on weekdays between 17:00 and 08:00, during weekends, and bank

holidays) You can also [email IT support](#) for non-urgent enquiries. We cannot respond within one working day. Call us if you need an immediate response.

Submit a query via the [Service Portal](#), where you can track IT support tickets. Visit our [IT service status page](#) to see the latest information about IT service availability and subscribe to email or SMS text notifications.

More information is available on the [Student App](#) and through [IT services and support](#).

3.13 Protect yourself and your data online

[Multi-Factor Authentication \(MFA\)](#) helps keep your data and account secure. You will need to set up MFA before you can access many University systems, including your timetable, the intranet, and Microsoft 365 account. Protect yourself, your information and devices by:

- installing anti-virus software and keeping it up to date. If you do not have your own, you can download [free anti-virus software](#)
- setting a strong password. Do not reuse a password on multiple sites. You can [reset your password online](#)
- ensuring your devices are lockable, protected, and having the latest operating system and security patches
- being aware of fraudulent emails, phone calls, and text messages, and how to keep yourself safe from [scams](#) and fraud
- using our [virtual private network \(VPN\)](#) if you need secure access to on-campus resources
- telling [IT Support](#) if you have clicked on a link or entered any details in a suspicious-looking email.

3.14 Communications

It is important to keep up to date with [university news](#) and [events](#) by checking your [university email](#) regularly and downloading our [Student App](#). Our [student communications commitment](#) explains how we will communicate with you and you can view a [list of the channels we'll use](#).

Your [student intranet](#) has information, advice, services, and applications and it is here to help with all aspects of student life.

4 How your degree works

4.1 Programme information

[SIMS](#) has information about your programme including teaching, assessments and learning outcomes.

Programme handbooks and descriptions of your modules are available on [Learning Central](#).

Sometimes reasonable changes will be made to your programme, as per the terms and conditions of your offer. More information can be found in the Variation of Arrangements statement in our [academic regulations](#).

4.2 Module options

Module options may be limited due to timetable clashes, places available or a minimum number of sign-ups to run. Some modules are mandatory for all students on a programme or require prior learning. You can seek advice on [module choices](#) from your personal tutor.

4.3 Blended Learning

We take a blended learning approach to our teaching that combines in-person and online engagement and activities. To help you make the most of the digital tools and platforms available, we have created the [Blended Learning at Cardiff University resource](#).

Find more information about specific tools and platforms on the [student intranet](#).

4.4 Learning Central

[Learning Central](#) is our virtual learning environment. It will be used to deliver your course content, activities and assessment. It provides information and tools to support your programme, including details about your teaching team, learning materials, and online assessments.

Find out more about using Learning Central from our [help guide](#).

4.5 The purpose of assessment

[Assessments](#) allow you to demonstrate your understanding, knowledge and skills, and evidence you have met the learning outcomes of your unit of study. They help staff and students monitor learning, whilst providing measures of achievement.

- 1) **Formative assessments:** help you learn more effectively through feedback on your performance, indicating how you can improve. It does not count towards your overall mark.
- 2) **Summative assessment:** used to indicate how well you have met the intended learning outcomes of a module or programme. It does count towards your overall mark. [Feedback is provided for all work](#) no later than 20 working days after the assessment deadline.

4.6 Assessments

You may be required to submit coursework, presentations, blogs or videos for assessment - guidance can be found on [Learning Central](#).

4.7 Examinations

All exam timetables are published on the [student intranet](#) and student timetabling system. Notification will be sent, approximately six weeks before the start of the [exam period](#). Resit timetables are published two weeks before. Once published, your individual exam information can be found on [your timetable](#).

4.8 Marking

Most assessment tasks require academic and/or professional judgement, which are supported by assessment criteria and/or mark schemes.

Most summative assessments are marked anonymously. Results are overseen by examining boards, which may include external examiners to help monitor and judge standards.

Word limits and assessment deadlines must be adhered to.

In cases where coursework is submitted late, and where there are no [extenuating circumstances](#):

- if the assessment is submitted no later than 24 hours after the deadline, the mark for the assessment will be capped at the minimum pass mark
- if the assessment is submitted more than 24 hours after the deadline, a mark of 0 will be given.

Find out more about [what to expect from feedback](#) on your assessments.

Your programme has an external examiner whose role it is to ensure that quality and standards are upheld. You can access [external examiner reports](#) from the last 5 years using your university login details.

4.9 Assessment results

[Provisional assessment results](#) will be made available on SIMS after an assessment has been marked. These are subject to confirmation by the relevant examining board.

Once your results have been confirmed by an examining board, you will receive your interim transcript via email. Results are also available to view on SIMS. You can [appeal against your results](#) within 28 days of receiving your transcript via email. Your transcript also has information about academic appeals.

If, having received your results, you need further information and support, you should contact your home school or personal tutor in the first instance. You can also contact the [Student Connect](#) team in the [Centre for Student Life](#) and [Student Advice](#) in the Students' Union.

4.10 Feedback on assessment

How we feedback is outlined in our [academic feedback policy](#). Make the most of your feedback by learning [how to recognise it and use it effectively](#).

5 Making changes to your module or programme

5.1 Module transfers

You can only request to [change modules](#) within 14 days of the start of teaching, in accordance with specific regulations that relate to your programme and year. Any changes to module must be approved by the school(s) who teach them. Your personal tutor or another staff member in your school will be able to advise you.

5.2 Programme transfers

You may be able to [transfer to another programme](#), subject to meeting eligibility requirements and approval from the relevant school(s). This change must be made within 14 days of the start of teaching.

5.3 Student academic representation

There are over 1,000 [student representatives](#) in the university. They bring your feedback to Student-Staff Panels, where staff, academic reps, and students discuss feedback and review proposals for changes. They can also signpost you to the range of support available to you. Find out [who your rep is and how to become a rep](#).

5.4 College Forums

Issues that affect your College are discussed at [College Forums](#), held once each semester.

6 Welsh language

We are committed to creating the best possible Welsh language student experience whilst ensuring your rights under the [Welsh Language Standards](#) are met. We offer a range of [subjects where students can study through the medium of Welsh, or partly in Welsh](#). We also offer the [Cardiff Citizen module](#) to all first-year students, if you tell us at enrolment that you have Welsh-language skills. Students can have access to a Welsh-speaking personal tutor and can submit assignments through the medium of Welsh, regardless of whether the course or module is taught in English. [Scholarships](#), [career advice](#), and [disability and dyslexia advice](#) are also available for students studying through the medium of Welsh.

6.1 Learn Welsh Cardiff

Learning Welsh allows students to develop a greater linguistic awareness and become a part of the Welsh culture within the university, the capital city, and Wales. [Learn Welsh Cardiff](#) provides free Welsh courses for all, from complete beginners to fluent Welsh speakers to increase their confidence.

6.2 Coleg Cymraeg Cenedlaethol Welsh Language Skills Certificate

The [Welsh Language Skills Certificate qualification](#) provides evidence of your level of Welsh-language skills, and of your ability to use Welsh in the workplace. It is also supported by a Welsh Language Tutor and offers study skills support. Register through the Cardiff Coleg Cymraeg Branch by emailing cangen@caerdydd.ac.uk.

6.3 Undeb Myfyrwyr Cymraeg Caerdydd

[Undeb Myfyrwyr Cymraeg Caerdydd](#) (UMCC) in the Students' Union is responsible for representing Welsh speakers, learners, and anyone interested in the Welsh language and culture at Cardiff University. It is governed by students and works with Welsh students and societies to guarantee that events and services are offered to Welsh-speaking students.

The Vice President Cymraeg is elected by students and represents the Welsh Language community as part of the full-time [Sabbatical Officer](#) team that leads the Students' Union.

7 Your support services and looking after yourself

7.1 Student Connect

If you need support contact [Student Connect](#). You can:

- visit the Student Connect desk in the [Centre for Student Life](#)
- use the [Student Connect portal](#)
- use the chatbot when you are logged into the student intranet by clicking the blue and white chat button on the bottom right-hand corner of your screen
- phone +44 (0)29 2251 8888.

7.2 Feeling unwell, reporting an absence and having a trusted contact

Make sure you are [registered with a doctor](#). If you [feel unwell](#) contact your doctor, [NHS Wales](#) or other agencies responsible for providing care to you when needed. **The university, as a provider of higher education, does not have the expertise or capacity to closely monitor students' mental or physical health, nor provide health care.**

If the university becomes aware that you are unwell, and has concerns for your welfare, we may engage a third party to help. To support this, we ask you to provide details of a [trusted contact](#) in SIMS.

If you are [unwell](#) and unable to attend in-person teaching, you should inform your school from the first day of absence or as soon as possible thereafter.

- **If you are absent for more than 7 consecutive working days:** speak to your personal tutor or staff in your school office. Absence due to illness for periods longer than seven consecutive days must be supported by a medical certificate, provided and signed by a medical practitioner, GP or doctor.

- **If you are absent for 14 days or more:** you will need to apply for an [interruption of study](#) or [extenuating circumstances](#), unless you have submitted a programme transfer, or you may be requested to withdraw.

If you are unwell and have an upcoming assessment, you can use the [extenuating circumstances](#) process.

If you have queries, speak to your personal tutor, school office or [Student Connect](#). Impartial advice is also available from [Student Advice](#) in the Students' Union.

Further information regarding absences is available in the [academic regulations handbook](#).

International students with a Student Visa who withdraw from their course or take an interruption of study of more than 60 days will be reported to the UK Home Office, which will result in their visa being cancelled. If you are an international student considering either withdrawing or taking an interruption of studies, contact [Student Visa Support](#).

7.3 Health, wellbeing and safety

Our dedicated [Health and Wellbeing team](#) is here to help you look after yourself while at university. We offer a wide range of [self-help resources](#), along with [workshops, courses, therapeutic groups, events, peer support](#), and professional [one-to-one appointments](#) all designed to help you manage your emotional, mental, and physical health.

If you are concerned about your personal safety, or have experienced an incident of violence and abuse, [get urgent advice](#).

Our [health, safety, and environment](#) policies are in place to support and protect students, staff and our environment. The [Health and Safety at Work Act](#) provides a legal framework for safety regulations.

You should [report any accident or incident](#) which happens on university premises or involves any individual engaged with Cardiff University business, whether in the UK or abroad. This helps us to learn lessons from incidents, and is designed to comply with the [reporting of injuries, disease and dangerous occurrences regulations](#).

We are committed to providing a safe and supportive learning environment. Equally, you have a responsibility for your own wellbeing. If you are unwilling or unable to manage your own wellbeing, and it is felt that there is good reason to intervene, we will do so in line with our [student support intervention policy and procedure](#).

7.4 Report and Support

We are committed to creating a safe, respectful, and inclusive community for all. [Report and Support](#) is a confidential and easy-to-use online tool for you to report incidents of:

- assault
- bullying

- discrimination
- harassment
- hate crime
- sexual misconduct
- and serious mental health concerns.

You can make a report anonymously or give details about yourself or others. Choose the route that feels most comfortable for you, or the individual you are reporting for. You do not need to log-in to use Report and Support and all information will be treated sensitively and confidentially. All reports are handled by our [trauma-informed specialist practitioners](#) who are here to support you.

If you or someone else is experiencing violence or abuse and are in immediate danger, call the emergency services on 999.

7.5 University residences

All residences have a [Residences Management Team](#) to support students in university accommodation. Learn more about [living in residences](#), including community living, health and safety, room transfers, and leaving residences.

Your [Residence Life Team](#) are also here to help you settle in, provide advice and assist with issues around community living. Join their free events and activities throughout the year and keep up to date [through their website](#).

7.6 Financial support and money advice

The [Advice and Money team](#) are here to support you with your finances. They can help with budgeting, offer advice on funding and if you're running low on money while you're studying, they can help you access emergency assistance from the university's [Money Support Fund \(MSF\)](#).

Contact the team via [Student Connect](#) or visit them in the Centre for Student Life.

7.7 Multi-faith chaplaincy

The [Multi-faith chaplaincy](#) is a place of friendship, hospitality, reflection, support, and dialogue. The chaplaincy provides spiritual pastoral care for students and staff, with or without faith.

7.8 Supporting your student life – equality, diversity and inclusion

[Additional support](#) is available to you via [Student Connect](#), including financial support and a dedicated contact, if your personal circumstances are listed below:

- asylum seekers and refugees
- care experienced
- disability and dyslexia
- estranged students

- military experienced
- gender reassignment
- LGBTQ+ students
- religion and belief
- student carers.

7.9 Student parents

If you already have a child or are about to become a parent, our [Advice and Money team](#) can help make sure you are receiving the funding you are entitled to and discuss any expected changes to your studies.

Being pregnant, adopting, or caring for a child should not be a barrier to succeeding in your studies. If you need help in finding childcare or locating a school, [Student Connect](#) can signpost you to other services and organisations.

The university has a registered [Little Scholars Nursery](#) for dependents of students and staff.

Advice and assistance on [bringing your family to the UK with you](#) is available for international students via [Student Connect](#).

7.10 Student Advice – Students' Union

Student Advice is a free, confidential, independent, and impartial advice service provided by the Students' Union, based on the third floor of the [Students' Union building](#).

Contact the Student Advice team through their [website](#), by emailing advice@cardiff.ac.uk or by calling +44(0)29 2078 1410.

7.11 Nightline

[Cardiff Nightline](#) is a confidential, student-led, term-time listening service. It serves as a listening ear if you need someone to listen and help explore how you are feeling.

The phonenumber +44(0)29 2087 0555 is available Wednesdays and Saturdays from 20:00-08:00. The [Instant Messaging service](#) is available from 08:00-00:00 on Wednesdays and Saturdays.

7.12 Academic study skills

We offer support to all undergraduate and postgraduate taught students to [develop your skills](#) in essay writing, note taking, and critical reading and thinking. Students can access this support via:

- [Classes](#) lasting 50 minutes and involving discussion, interactive activities and question and answer sessions. [Book a class](#).

- [Resources](#) to work through at your own pace, including handouts, templates to structure your work, recorded lectures, interactive tutorials, and videos to guide you through a range of topics.

For more information, contact the Academic Study Skills and Mentoring team via [Student Connect](#).

7.13 Online resources

Resources available to support the [development of your study skills](#) cover:

- critical analysis
- managing and citing information sources
- academic writing
- research skills, such as literature review and research methodology.

Our [Academic Study Skills module](#) includes interactive tutorials to work through at your own pace and templates to help structure your work

7.14 Disabled students

Contact the [Student Disability Service](#) as early as possible to discuss your needs and the specialist support and adjustments that may be available to you.

7.15 Maths and statistics support

The [Maths Support Service](#) is available to all students, with drop-in sessions, specialised workshops and online learning materials available.

7.16 Learn a new language

If you're interested in learning a new language or building on your existing skills, [Uniwide Languages](#) offers a variety of courses you can take alongside your studies.

7.17 English language support

If English is not your first language, you can [access tailored support](#) to help develop your academic English skills, both in person and online.

7.18 Study spaces

[Study spaces](#) are available in all libraries, a selection of university buildings and the Student's Union without booking in advance. Choose from quiet areas, collaborative spaces, desks with or without electrical sockets, height-adjustable desks and open-access PCs.

8 Your future career

[Student Futures](#) provide employability support for students and recent graduates. This includes careers advice, CV and application support, skills development, careers fairs and events along with online tools and the Jobs Board. Manage bookings and browse jobs and opportunities on your [Student Futures Account](#).

If you are looking to work, study or volunteer abroad, or have an idea for starting your own business, our [Global Opportunities](#) and [Enterprise and Start-up](#) teams are here to help.

8.1 Student Mentor Scheme

The [Student Mentor Scheme](#) helps new students settle into university life. If you're a first-year undergraduate, you will be allocated a student mentor from your academic school. Once you've found your feet we'll be in touch with the opportunity [to become a mentor](#), helping you to improve your employability skills and help incoming first-year undergraduate students.

8.2 Your Higher Education Achievement Report

When you graduate, many of your activities will be included in your [Higher Education Achievement Report](#) (HEAR). It's a digital record, allowing you to present your achievements to employers and further education providers.

8.3 Volunteering

The Students' Union offers a wide variety of different and exciting [volunteering](#) opportunities. Volunteering is a great way to make a difference in your new community. You'll also gain skills that employers will look for, meet new people, and of course have lots of fun!

You can also explore volunteering abroad with [Global Opportunities](#).

International students who need a visa to study in the UK should speak to [Student Visa Support](#) before volunteering as some activities may affect your working conditions.

9 Academic Regulations

As well as the information here, you will also need to refer to the academic regulations section in your academic school section of this handbook (section 17).

9.1 Attending lectures and completing work

You are expected to:

- attend all your programme activities
- complete your assigned work
- achieve satisfactory results in your assessed work
- become an independent and self-directed learner.

If you fail to meet the attendance requirements of your course, you will receive a warning from the Head of School (or nominee). If you receive a warning and need advice, contact [Student Connect](#) or [Student Advice](#).

Further information is available in our student study and engagement regulations within the [academic regulations handbook](#).

Be aware that if you receive tuition fees from the [Student Loans Company](#) or a university bursary, you will be required to confirm your attendance during the year to ensure funds are released to you. International students with Student Visas who fail to meet attendance requirements will be reported to the UK Home Office.

Check what to do if you [feel unwell and how to report an absence](#). Information on extenuating circumstances can be found in section 9.4 or on the [student intranet](#). If your [mental health and wellbeing](#) has impacted your workload and attendance, contact [Student Connect](#) for support.

9.2 Seeking guidance and support

If things aren't meeting your expectations, you should [get in touch](#) and raise your concerns with your personal tutor, [Student Connect](#) or [Student Advice](#) as soon as possible (within 28 days) and seek advice if these are not resolved. You should inform us promptly if:

- there are any changes to your circumstances
- your own experience is adversely affected by the behaviour of fellow students or staff
- your academic progress, or any other aspect of your experience, gives you cause for concern.

9.3 Alternative examination arrangements

You can apply for [alternative arrangements](#) that allow you to:

- have reasonable adjustments. Apply as soon as you start university, if you can. The deadline for us to process arrangements is 8 weeks before your examination.
- avoid religious observance days. If you are unable to sit an exam on a certain day or at a certain time you must let us know by week 3 of each semester.
- sit your exams in Welsh
- sit your examinations away from the university.

9.4 Extenuating circumstances

You are expected to submit all assessments by the published deadlines and attend assessment activities as scheduled.

If you experience a severe and exceptional circumstance in the period immediately before, or during, an assessment, you must submit a declaration of extenuating circumstances to your school.

To be considered as an [extenuating circumstance](#), your situation must meet all of these criteria:

- be severe and exceptional; and

- unforeseen or unavoidable; and
- close in time to the assessment, or where you can demonstrate that the circumstances continued to have an impact on your ability to complete assessments or to undertake examinations.

When you experience extenuating circumstances, you will usually be unable to complete the assessment as scheduled and must [declare your circumstances](#) before the assessment deadline. There are limited situations when you can declare extenuating circumstances after starting or having completed an assessment.

9.5 Academic integrity

It is essential that you understand what academic integrity is, and how to avoid academic misconduct. You must complete your assessments and exams honestly, fairly and respectfully.

You can find guidance on artificial intelligence, academic integrity, contract cheating, plagiarism, collusion, and academic misconduct on the [student intranet](#) and links to complete an academic integrity module on [Learning Central](#).

Your [subject librarian](#) can also help with referencing queries.

We use a range of different tools and techniques to identify academic misconduct. The penalties for students can be severe. Invigilators are also trained to identify misconduct in examinations. It is up to you to ensure that you don't commit an unfair practice, even unintentionally – it is an offence either way. Further information is available in our [academic integrity policy](#).

9.6 Student behaviour, conduct and discipline

You are expected to demonstrate respect for the university, staff, fellow students, and the local community on and off campus. We operate a zero tolerance approach to behaviours of harassment, bullying and victimisation and are committed to establishing an inclusive culture, free from discrimination, and based on [dignity, courtesy, and respect](#).

If students behave in a way that contradicts this, we may act using the [student conduct procedure](#) and the [Fitness to Practise](#) procedure for students who are studying on programmes leading to professional registration.

If you experience harassment, bullying, hate crime, violence or abuse use [Report and Support](#) to tell us what happened and access specialist support.

9.7 Student complaints procedure

All students have the right to submit a complaint – either as an individual or as a group. Complaints must be raised within 28 days of the concern arising – or the latest occurrence of the incident if it's ongoing.

Read our [student complaint procedure](#) to understand what you can submit a complaint about, the procedure for handling the complaint, possible outcomes and the complaint form.

9.8 Thinking of leaving

If you are struggling with your course or finding it is not what you expected and you are [considering withdrawing from your programme](#), discuss this first with your personal tutor, supervisor, school office, or the [Advice and Money team](#) or [Student Advice](#). There are many people here to support you and explain your options (e.g. taking an [interruption of study](#)).

If you are an international student and believe that [withdrawing or taking an interruption of study](#) may be the best option for you, discuss your situation with the [Student Visa Support team](#) first. If you withdraw or take an interruption of study, UK Visas and Immigration will expect you to return to your home country, as you were issued with a visa to study in the UK. You will need to make a new visa application when/if you choose to return to the UK to resume your studies.

10 After you complete your degree

10.1 Graduation

[Graduation](#) is a time to celebrate your success alongside family and friends. Graduation events are held in July.

10.2 Graduate advice and support

For three years after you graduate you can keep accessing [career advice and support](#). This includes face-to-face consultations, mock interviews, CV checks, careers resources, job-specific information, and a jobs board.

10.3 Moving on to postgraduate study

Considering [continuing into further study](#) after your undergraduate degree? We have a postgraduate community known globally for outstanding research and teaching, and you can receive an [alumni discount](#).

10.4 Graduate Outcomes survey

It's important that you enter a personal email address in [SIMS](#) as 15 months after your course ends you will be asked to complete a national survey called [Graduate Outcomes](#).

This UK government survey is sent to all UK University graduates. Your responses will help future students by evaluating your degree programme and contributing to the university's position in league tables.

10.5 Requesting a reference

If you [require a reference](#) for an application for a job or further study, ask your personal tutor.

10.6 Verification of study and replacement certificates

Once your award has been conferred by the Awards and Progress Committee, you will receive a hard copy of your [degree certificate](#). You can also access digital copies of your certificate and Higher Education Achievement Report via [Verify](#) and share these documents with third parties including employers and other Higher Education institutions. If your original degree certificate is lost or destroyed, you can [request a replacement](#).

11 Our alumni community

Cardiff is for life! Even after you graduate, we're here for you. You'll join a [global alumni community](#) of over 200,000 and can access alumni support, benefits and discounts. Make sure you opt in to alumni communications when you enrol, and we'll keep you connected with your Cardiff community and up to date with news, opportunities and events.

12 Welcome to the School of Computer Science and Informatics

You are part of a vibrant community of undergraduate and postgraduate students pursuing taught degree programmes within the school. As you progress through your degree, you will find that your study is influenced by both the strong research of the school and the professional accreditation requirements of the British Computer Society and The Chartered Institute for IT. You can find out more about research in the school [here](#).

The school is one of seven academic schools within Cardiff University which make up the College of Physical Sciences & Engineering: a centre of academic excellence, internationally renowned for research and teaching excellence, innovation, industrial engagement, sustainable solutions, and societal impact.

We're always keen to hear your thoughts about your experience studying with us. In this section of the handbook, you'll find information about who to contact within COMSC if you need advice, have a concern, or simply want to share something—whether it's a challenge or a success.

Kathryn Jones
Head of School
JonesK90@cardiff.ac.uk



12.1 Meet the Student Services Team

Our Student Services Team is here to support you throughout your time university. We offer guidance and assistance across a wide range of areas, including:

- Enrolment and module selection
- Extenuating circumstances and academic support
- Enhancing your student experience and gathering feedback
- Employability, careers advice, and placements

If you need help or have any questions, please don't hesitate to get in touch. You can reach the Student Services team by

 Email: comsc-office@cardiff.ac.uk

 Telephone: +44 (0) 29 2087 4812

 Or pop into your nearest Student Hub.

Name	Role
Anna Griffiths	Postgraduate Teaching Support Administrator
Alys Perry	Student Services Officer
Barry Hogan	Administrative Officer / Student Wellbeing
Brachann Davies	Teaching Allocation Co-Ordinator
Craig Davies	Student Services Administrator
Eli Ferreira	Student Services Administrator
Emma Pullen	Placements Officer
Gill Price	Administrative Assistant
Joanna Emery	Industry and External Engagement Manager
Justin James	Industry and External Engagement Officer
Leigh Hodge	Education and Students Manager
Lucy Burns	Student Services Manager
Matthew Strangis	Student Services Administrator
Sarah Bollingham	Student Services Administrator
Tom Grey	Administrative Officer / Student Experience

The school's disability contact is Barry Hogan. For details on reasonable adjustments and the support available. [Please see this page.](#)

12.2 Meet the Facilities and Safety Team

Name	Role
Abigail Rutherford	Building, Facilities, and Health & Safety Manager
Luke Vermirovsky	Facilities Assistant

The Facilities & Safety team are responsible for the efficient operation of COMSC buildings, including implementing and maintaining safety measures, maintenance upkeep, and security systems, as well as ensuring the overall functionality of the space for building users.

Email – Abacws@cardiff.ac.uk

Telephone – 07354167095

12.3 Meet the Outreach Team

The Outreach Team regularly visit primary and secondary schools in the local area to inspire the next generation of computer scientists. We also host events in Abacws and attend pop-up community events.

If you are interested in becoming a STEM Ambassador and helping to support their work you can contact the team by:

Email – comscambassadors@cardiff.ac.uk

Telephone – 029225 14598 or 029225 12346

Name	Role
Luiza Patorski	Outreach Officer
Sally Burkitt-Harrington	Outreach Officer
Abby Williams	Development and Delivery Officer
Gaurav Menon	Development and Delivery Officer

12.4 Meet the Technical Services Team

The Technical Services Team manages the School's Workshop services, and also a Maker Space, where equipment includes 3D printers, a laser cutter, soldering stations and electronics prototyping equipment.

We support students through the provision of non-IT technical equipment for projects, dissertations, and some modules.

If you have any questions you can contact the team by:

Email – COMSC-Technical@cardiff.ac.uk

Name	Role
David Sivell	Technical Services Manager
Farid Bungay-Azman	Technical Services Officer
Darral Clark	Technical Services Officer
Christine Burns	Administrative Assistant

13 Getting started

13.1 Hybiau

You'll find new student Hybiau opening across our campuses including a local Hyb for your discipline. We've invested in these student spaces to give you easy access to the support you need and provide collaborative study space to build your university community. We can't wait for you to start using them.

During the start of this academic year Hybiau will be getting up and running to deliver a whole range of support and services. We'll be in touch soon to tell you more about what you can expect. In the meantime, please follow the welcome information from your school and enjoy the start of your university life at Cardiff!

Hybiau is the plural form of Hyb in Welsh (pronounced huh-bee-eye).

13.2 Student ID Card

13.2.1 Collection and Usage

All students must collect their Student ID card within the first two weeks of the academic year. Cards are available from the Centre for Student Life on Park Place and must be collected before borrowing any equipment provided by the School.

Your Student ID card is essential for:

- Accessing computing labs and other school facilities
- Borrowing equipment from the School office
- Using University libraries, including borrowing books
- Entering school buildings outside teaching hours

You must carry your Student ID card at all times while on campus. Staff or security may request to see it, and failure to present a valid card may result in being asked to leave the premises.

13.2.2 Card Updates

Student ID cards must be updated every 30 days. Update points are located:

- Outside Room 0.19 (Ground Floor, Abacws)
- On the accessibility door to Room 3.36 (Third Floor, Staff Room)

To update your card, hold it against the panel until the blue light turns green. If you encounter any issues with updating or using your card, please visit the Facilities team in Room 0.20 or email Abacws@cardiff.ac.uk.

13.3 Accessing additional IT support

If you have an IT problem or query, please contact the IT Service Desk, which offers 24-hour IT support, seven days a week:

 **Email:** Send queries or support requests to it-support@cardiff.ac.uk.

 **Telephone:** For immediate assistance, call **+44 (0)29 2251 1111** (available 24/7).

Find out more about IT services and support [here](#).

Help and advice about online safety and to support you in identifying phishing emails is available on the [intranet](#).

Remember: Cardiff University will never email you asking you to validate your email account or to warn you that your mailbox is full! Please contact the IT Service Desk for further information.

Shortly after you first enrol, you will be given guidance on the use of the school's computing facilities. Information on the School's systems and software can be found [here](#). In the Documentation section, you will find a selection of documents describing the school's facilities and how to use them. If you require further help using the systems in the laboratories, you should contact the IT service desk or speak to the school's IT support team.

Faults and maintenance requirements, including printer faults, jams and lack of toner, should be reported to the IT team via email IT-Support@cardiff.ac.uk.

You will be able to use the school's PC labs for your own work outside of scheduled teaching sessions, though precedence should always be given to those who require specific equipment for coursework. Please Note: these labs are exclusively for the use of COMSC students only.

13.4 Free Software

As a Cardiff University student, you are entitled to install Microsoft Office on your home computer for free, and to continue using it for as long as you are a Cardiff University student. Other free software and information is listed [here](#). Information on School-specific systems, software, services, and documentation can be found at [COMSC SCHOOL.ORG](#). It is strongly recommended that you install Microsoft Teams, Microsoft Office, Microsoft OneDrive, etc. on your computer. <mailto:it-support@cardiff.ac.uk><mailto:it-support@cardiff.ac.uk>

13.5 Raising Issues in Computer Labs

Students requiring technical assistance within Cardiff University computer labs can contact IT Support through the following channels:

-  **Email:** Send queries or support requests to it-support@cardiff.ac.uk.
-  **Telephone:** For immediate assistance, call **+44 (0)29 2251 1111** (available 24/7).

13.6 Semester dates

The teaching year is split into two teaching semesters, Autumn and Spring. There is also a re-sit assessment period in Summer. For postgraduate taught master's programmes there is also a Dissertation stage which follows completion of the taught period.

Dates for the standard university periods can be found [here](#).

Please note that for joint programmes where COMSC is not the home school, the semester and dissertation dates may be different, and you should contact your home school for that information.

13.7 BCS Membership

BCS student membership brings immediate benefits such as support for their learning through regular webinars run by specialist groups and branches, access to the BCS library, and discounts and offers on items such as laptops. As BCS members, students sign up to the BCS professional code of conduct, designed to maintain ethical standards within the IT industry. On completion of their BCS accredited degree, graduates are eligible to apply for chartered and professional status, with continued access to an international network of IT professionals and experts, and support for their career progression through mentoring, industry engagement, professional skills development programmes and career development tools aligned with the SFIA framework.

14 How your degree works

14.1 Calculation of Overall Degree Results

Your degree average is calculated based on the average mark achieved for each year or stage. The weightings for each year or stage vary depending on the type of programme.

For undergraduate degrees, the marks for the first year are excluded from the calculation, with each of the other years contributing a percentage of the final mark as outlined in the table below:

Programme	Year 2	Year in Industry/Year of Study Abroad	Year 3	Year 4
BSc Computer Science Programmes	30%		70%	
BSc Computer Science with Year in Industry or Year of Study Abroad Programmes	20%	10%	70%	
BSc Applied Software Engineering/ BSc Applied Software Engineering Degree Apprenticeship	40		60%	
MSci Computer Science	20%		30%	50%
MSci Computer Science with Year in Industry or Year of Study Abroad	10%	10%	30%	50%

For postgraduate degrees, the contributions from each year or stage are as follows:

Programme	Taught Stage	Placement/Professional Placement Year	Dissertation Stage
MSc Programmes	50%		50%
MSc Programmes with Placement or Professional Placement Year	45%	10%	45%

14.2 Learning Central

[Learning Central](#) is the University's Virtual Learning Environment and is where the majority of the material for your learning and teaching will be found.

You will be expected to log into Learning Central at least once a week. Your modules will have a section for learning resources, which are likely to be updated throughout the programme, and an announcements page where the module leader may post important information, such as confirmation of practical session timings or any changes to key dates. You will also find other useful resources on the [COMSC School Learning Central page](#).

14.3 Coursework

Most of your modules will include an element of assessed coursework, details of which are given in the module descriptions on [SIMS](#).

Information on when coursework will be set, and the associated submission date(s) will be made available from the start of the semester on Learning Central. This will give you an overview for the entire semester workload to enable you to plan your work.

14.3.1 Coursework Submission

Coursework should be submitted electronically via Learning Central as specified in the coursework instructions. If you are unable to submit your work on Learning Central due to technical difficulties, please email your submission to the module leader and comsc-submissions@cardiff.ac.uk, including the module code in the subject line. If the technical issue relates to Cardiff University systems, please also report it to [University IT Support](#):

 **Email:** Send queries or support requests to it-support@cardiff.ac.uk.

 **Telephone:** For immediate assistance, call **+44 (0)29 2251 1111** (available 24/7).

<https://intranet.cardiff.ac.uk/students/it-support/it-service-desk>

14.3.2 Late Submission

Late submissions are treated in accordance with the University policy. [Information about this policy can be found here.](#)

If you face extenuating circumstances just before or during an assessment, it's important to let us know by submitting a declaration of extenuating circumstances. You'll find more details about how to do this in Section 9.4 of this handbook. [Information about the policy can also be found here.](#)

14.4 Examinations

Examinations are typically held online, via Learning Central. The exam periods and timetables can be [found on the intranet](#).

The exam timetables are published 6 weeks prior to the start of the autumn and spring exam periods (and 2 weeks prior to the resit exam period).

14.5 Marking

We aim to return all assessment marks within **20 working days** of the submission deadline. If, for any reason, this timeframe cannot be met, we will inform students as soon as possible.

All assessments are checked internally by appropriate academic members of staff before they are released to students. Assessments that contribute to degree classification (i.e. all but those

In Year 1 of undergraduate programmes) are also checked and approved by external examiners.

Where a coursework assessment forms a substantial part of a module's assessment, a sample of the assessments for the cohort is reviewed by appropriate members of academic staff.

14.5.1 Provisional Marks

Each module mark is composed of marks for individual assessments (components) specified in the module description. All marks are **provisional** until they have been confirmed by an Examining Board, which usually takes place at the end of the teaching year. As part of this process, the Board may decide to adjust marks for a module, this means that provisional marks you received previously could be subject to change. After the meeting of the Examining Board, you will be sent a transcript by the Academic Registry.

14.5.2 Component and Module Marks

You will receive marks for each individual assessment (component) on a module. Details of assessments can be found in the module description. The mark overall mark for a module will be calculated according to the weightings for each element of summative assessment, specified in the module description, rounded, and recorded as a whole number (see section 2.5 of the [Academic Regulations](#)).

You can fail a module's assessed component in two ways:

- By obtaining a mark below the pass mark. The pass mark is 40% for undergraduate modules and 50% for postgraduate modules.
- By submitting more than 24 hours late or not at all.

Note: failing a module's assessed component does not necessarily mean you fail the whole module as the module mark is calculated from all assessed components.

14.5.3 Resits

If the Examining Board determines that you have failed no more than 60 credits in the academic year, you will be expected to resit modules you have not passed in the resit period. For further details, please see section 4.11 and 5.10 of the [Academic Regulations](#).

Resit assessments take place prior to the start of the following academic year. Resit coursework usually takes place in July and early August with exams and class tests taking place in the August resit period, dates of which can be found [here](#). Your resit results will be confirmed by the Resit Examining Board, which is normally held in the first week of September, following which, academic transcripts and year results will be sent to you by the Academic Registry.

If you have failed more than 60 credits during the academic year, you will not be eligible for resits in the August resit period. Depending on your results, you may be offered to repeat the year, or in some cases, will be asked to withdraw from your programme. For further details, please see section 4.14 and 5.13 of the [Academic Regulations](#).

The type of reassessment you will need to complete depends on the components you have failed. You may be required to resit more than one component if there are multiple failed components for a module. The resit component will be the same type as the original assessment (e.g., exam, coursework, etc).

At undergraduate level, you have a maximum of **three attempts** to pass a module. At postgraduate level, you have **two attempts** at a module. For further details, please see section 2.10 of the [Academic Regulations](#).

If you fail modules in the resit period and are unable to progress to the next phase of your programme (see section 14.5.4), you may be offered to repeat the year, or in some cases, will be asked to withdraw from your programme.

14.5.4 Progression

Note: this simplified guidance is to be read in conjunction with the University's [Academic Regulations](#).

UG Students:

Following the resit period, if you fail to pass up to 30 credits in a year, and have sufficient attempts left on the required modules, you may be allowed to progress and carry the module(s) into the following year (see Progression Rule 2 in section 4.8 of the [Academic Regulations](#)). These credits will be taken as an external student but must be passed before graduating with a degree.

PGT (one year programmes):

To progress from the taught part of the programme to the dissertation phase, you will need to attain 120 credits on the taught part of your programme.

14.5.5 COMSC additional Progression Rules

In addition to those outlined above, and defined in the [Academic Regulations](#), the following progression rules apply to programmes within COMSC.

CM2305 'Group Project' is a Required module for all second-year diets in which it appears. As it is a Required module, students cannot progress to their final year (or placement/year of study abroad if applicable) without passing this module.

14.5.6 Repeating the Year

If you are required to repeat the year, you have the option to repeat the year as either an internal or an external student. Guidance on the differences between repeating a module internally or externally can be found [here](#).

We highly recommend that students who are required to repeat the year do not repeat more than 60 credits (in total per year) as an external student. Students will be allowed to repeat more credits externally if they wish, but it is important to consider the risks associated with

doing so. A conversation with your personal tutor or other academic member of staff is recommended before making a decision.

14.6 Feedback on assessment

You will generally receive feedback on your assessment within 20 working days of the assessment deadline. However, there may be times when we are unable to meet the deadline. In these situations, we will endeavour to communicate with students that feedback will be late and when feedback can be expected.

Throughout your programme you will be set work as formative assessment (work that generates feedback on your progress but does not contribute to your grades) and summative assessment (work that generates feedback on your progress and contributes to your grades).

Summative assessment for each module consists of a set of assessed components, such as coursework, tests, portfolios, examinations, etc. You can find the details of how each of your modules is assessed in the module descriptions available on Learning Central. When summative assessments are set you will be given a written coursework specification which will indicate how marks will be awarded and the format in which submission is required.

Some summative assessment of modules also involves timetabled examinations. All students are provided with an individual electronic copy of the examination timetable by the University Registry prior to each Examination Period. It's also advisable to check the main timetable for our School [here](#).

Throughout your programme you will receive many forms of feedback, both, individual and group/cohort.

These may include:

- Written comments on summative assessments,
- Written comments on formative work,
- Written cohort feedback on summative assessments in the form of a summary of how the class performed in this assessment, common trends, pitfalls to avoid, etc.,
- Written cohort feedback on examinations,
- Verbal discussions during group or individual exercises,
- Verbal discussions with Lecturers / TAs (Teaching Associates) during lab classes,
- Verbal (mostly) feedback during demos, presentations, and interviews.

It's important to recognise that understanding and acting upon feedback you receive can make an impact on your learning. Click [here](#) for suggestions on how to use different types for feedback in your studies.

14.7 Placement Information for Undergraduate and Postgraduate Taught Students

The Placement Officer for the school is [Emma Pullen](#) who is here to support you in finding a placement opportunity for your Year in Industry as well as provide support across all employability issues.

If you are studying a "with Year in Industry" (Undergraduate) or "with Placement" / "with Professional Placement Year" (Postgraduate) variant of your programme, you will need to:

- Secure a suitable placement.
- Successfully complete the required academic phase:
 - Undergraduates: Must complete the second year.
 - Postgraduates: Must complete the taught phase.

Deadlines for obtaining a placement are specified in the Placements Handbook on Learning Central but will be around May/June.

If you are unable to find a suitable placement:

- Undergraduates will transfer to the non-placement version of the programme and proceed directly to the third/final year.
- Postgraduates will transfer to the non-placement version of the programme and proceed directly to the Dissertation stage.

After completing the placement:

- Undergraduates proceed to the third/final year.
- Postgraduates proceed to the Dissertation stage.

Pass Marks:

- Undergraduate placement: 40%
- Postgraduate placement: 50%

14.7.1 Finding a Placement

You are responsible for finding your own placement, but the School will support you by:

- Providing workshops and talks during the Autumn Semester on:
 - Applying for placements
 - Making the most of your placement experience
- Offering drop-in advisory sessions throughout the academic year
- Sending out a weekly email update with links to placement opportunities

If you do not secure a placement, there are alternative work experience opportunities available to help build your skills and enhance your CV.

[Jobs and Work Experience – Cardiff University Intranet](#)

14.7.2 Support and Employability Sessions

Throughout the year, the school offers a range of employability sessions, including:

- CV & Cover Letter Writing
- Articulating Skills
- Interview Tips
- Assessment Centre Preparation
- Pitching & Networking Masterclass
- LinkedIn Masterclass

The Placement Team is available for:

- One-to-one sessions for targeted advice
- Email support via COMSCPlacements@cardiff.ac.uk

Additional targeted events will be held to:

- Meet placement providers
- Practice networking skills

Many placement opportunities close before the Christmas recess, so start your search early!

14.8 Industry Engagement

The COMSC Industry and External Engagement team exists to support your pursuit to secure the perfect graduate position. Our team does this through connecting you with industry professionals, organisations and employers in events and sessions that help you to expand your network.

Throughout the year, look out for careers events (i.e. Tech Talent Harvest, #Love2Work4, Spring into Action), Hackathons, Guest Talks, Lunch 'n' Learns, workshops and more. Events may be held in Abacws or further afield and are tailored to give you the best opportunity to secure your dream job.

You can see some upcoming events, [here](#).

<mailto:COMSC-exchange@cardiff.ac.uk>

14.9 International Experience Options

Throughout your studies, there might be opportunities for you to spend time abroad. For queries about international student opportunities and mobility, please email: COMSC-exchange@cardiff.ac.uk

14.10 Health and Safety at Study

You will be given an introduction to Health and Safety within the School as part of the Induction and Welcome Programme. All students are required to adhere to the safety measures outlined in that presentation, which will also be shared with students on Learning Central.

To report Health and Safety Issues, please email: Abacws@cardiff.ac.uk.

14.11 Additional Information for Integrated Degree Students

The weighting of the MSci degree is provided in Section 14, How Your Degree Works.

Students will take the three years of the BSc Computer Science course, then (assuming progression criteria are met) will progress onto a fourth year of study during which you will take Advanced Computer Science modules and complete a 40 credit team project. This will lead to the qualification of Master of Computer Science (MSci) provided you acquire the appropriate number of credits.

After the third year of the course, if students do not wish to progress onto the fourth year of study, they can withdraw from the course and graduate with a BSc degree, if the appropriate credits are gained. Students who wish to do this need to inform the school by emailing COMSC-Office@cardiff.ac.uk

14.12 Useful contacts

The names, email addresses and telephone numbers of all staff in the School of Computer Science & Informatics can be found on our '[Key Contacts](#)' .

For all general academic queries or even if you are just not sure, please e-mail our Student Services Team at COMSC-Office@cardiff.ac.uk

For general pastoral queries, please email your personal tutor in the first instance, but if your query is urgent, please email our Student Experience team at COMSC-Studentvoiceandsupport@cardiff.ac.uk

To make general queries about Extenuating Circumstances (ECs) - COMSC-ExtenCircs@cardiff.ac.uk

*please note that you cannot submit ECs to this mailbox.

If you have an academic query related to a specific module, please contact the Module Leader in the first instance. If your query remains unresolved, you should then raise the matter with the appropriate Year Tutor (for undergraduate programmes) or the Programme Lead (for postgraduate programmes).

Should the issue still not be resolved to your satisfaction, you may escalate it to the Director of Learning and Teaching (for undergraduate programmes) or the Director of Postgraduate Taught Programmes (for MSc programmes).

A range of useful contacts for the wider University is available [here](#).

14.12.1 COMSC Student Services Team

Our team are here to help you with queries about Extenuating Circumstances, Interruption of Study, changing course, changing modules, assessments and resits and many other things.

There are several ways for you to contact the team:

 Email COMSC-office@cardiff.ac.uk

 Telephone: +44 (0) 29 2087 4812 (8.30am – 4.30pm)

Or visit the nearest Student Hub.

Staff will be available between 8:30am – 4:30pm during the working week.

Staff will be more than happy to help with any queries that you have, but if you need help and guidance accessing the university's student support services then you can speak to our Student Wellbeing Officer, Barry Hogan via COMSC-studentvoiceandsupport@cardiff.ac.uk

15 Making the most of your student experience

15.1 Student Voice - Student-Staff Panels

[Student-Staff Panels](#) (SSPs) provide a formal channel for your student representatives to meet with staff and discuss issues related to your education. They also provide an opportunity for the school to consult with students and receive feedback on proposals.

As a school, we're committed to working in partnership with you to make our community the best it can be. We want to listen to your concerns, make meaningful changes, and continue building a school we can all be proud of. Student-staff panels, to which your year and programme will be asked to elect representatives, are in place for both undergraduate and postgraduate students. Your Panel, which meets at least once each semester, reports directly to the School's Board of Studies (BOS) and the School Education and Student Experience Committee (SESEC), both of which have student representation. The Panel is accustomed to openly discussing any topic affecting students and will receive any representation from you, made via your year representative(s). The Chairs of both the UG & PGT Student Staff Panels also attend the School's BOS and SESEC, to discuss any high priority matters, which may need to be addressed by the school's senior management.

You don't need to wait for a panel meeting to raise any concerns. If something is troubling you, please feel free to speak with your Student Representative, who can raise the issue on your behalf with the appropriate staff member (such as the Module Leader, Year Tutor, or Programme Lead) and communicate the outcome back to you. Alternatively, you can discuss the matter directly with your Personal Tutor. If you're unsure which route to take, the Student Services Team is always available to guide you.

Details about your Student Academic Representative(s) will be shared with you by email. They will reach out to their peers directly for student feedback throughout the academic year.

15.2 Your Student Voice

[Tell us how things are going](#) for you during your studies and what we can do to help support you better. Your feedback plays a vital role in helping us continuously evaluate and enhance our programmes and services. Thanks to student input, we've been able to implement meaningful improvements across the School. You can explore examples of these changes [here](#).

You can also contact the student representative for your course. Their contact details will be shared during the first few weeks of the autumn semester. Alternatively, you're welcome to get in touch via email COMSC-Studentvoiceandsupport@cardiff.ac.uk

15.3 Module Enhancement

Module Enhancement comprises of evaluation surveys for each of your taught modules. It provides you with an opportunity to anonymously share your thoughts on your modules, help

shape the teaching in the school and influence the experience that students will have next year. Your feedback is important so please do ensure you take the time to complete these surveys. The survey is short and should only take a few minutes to complete for each module.

You will have an opportunity to complete mid-module enhancement surveys halfway through each semester, to enable you to feedback on any issues that can be addressed directly. You will also be able to complete surveys for each module you study at the end of each semester, so you can reflect back on the module as a whole. For the end of module surveys, you will receive email reminders with a direct link to survey, which is on the [Blue Explorance](#) system, when you need to complete the survey for modules in each semester.

15.4 Course-Based Societies

Please refer to the [Student Union Society page](#).

16 Supporting Your Time at university

16.1 Study Spaces

In response to student feedback, we have recently established a dedicated study area on the second floor for COMSC and MATHS students. This space is equipped with essential resources, including monitors, keyboards, and mice, to support focused and collaborative study.

Students can book spaces in the Abacws building, the Centre for Student Life, and other university spaces via the [Cardiff University Resource Booker](#). Desks in the Computer Labs can be booked during and outside standard teaching hours, while rooms 2.14, 3.65 and 5.48 are ideal spaces for students to use for group work. There are numerous desks and breakaway areas in Abacws for students to use as a place to study throughout the year. These spaces at the North & South end of the building, along with the desks in the atrium levels and the corridor seating areas on the ground floor, do not require booking.

There is limited out of hours access to the Abacws building available for students. There is a Security Guard on site from 8pm to 8am that can grant access to students who have booked to use the Computer Labs or the second-floor study space. For more information please visit the [Facilities SharePoint here](#).

Additionally, postgraduate students can request 24-hour access to the Abacws building. To have 24-hour access added to your student ID card, please contact the Facilities and Safety Team by emailing Abacws@cardiff.ac.uk. Please note that we are only able to offer this to postgraduate students.

The Science Library is located on the first floor of the Main Building and contains collections relating to Computer Science & Informatics.

16.2 Your Personal Tutor

You will receive information about the [personal tutor system](#) during induction. Your personal tutor's name will also be listed on your SIMS account. They are there to maintain an overview of your learning and educational experiences, and can provide you with academic advice and guidance, as well as signpost you to specialised central support services for any non-

academic matters. Your personal tutor should meet with you within the first two weeks of each academic session and at least once per semester.

During induction week, the school will provide you with an outline of the personal tutor schedule for the academic year and will include the sessions that you need to attend, in accordance with the University's student [Attendance & Engagement policy](#).

If you wish to change your personal tutor, please do contact COMSCStudentvoiceandsupport@cardiff.ac.uk in the first instance. You will not, at the first request, be required to state your reason.

All Welsh-speaking students have the right to support from a Welsh-speaking personal tutor. Where there are none in your subject area, every effort will be made to allocate a Welsh speaker from a similar school. Please do let us know if this is something that you would like for us to arrange.

16.3 Your Student Mentor

During induction week we will tell you about your student mentor group – most first-year students have a mentor who will help ease your transition to university. Your [Student Mentor](#) will be from your school and be a source of key tips and advice. Being part of the group will also help you meet other first-year students on your course.

17 Academic Regulations in my School

17.1 Extenuating Circumstances

If you need to declare extenuating circumstances for an assessment, please use the online [Extenuating Circumstances Declaration Tool](#) to do so.

You can watch a demonstration of this service, online [here](#).

This service is being trialled in partnership with a select group of Schools across the university and is designed to help improve efficiencies and, most importantly, your student experience. After each submitted declaration students are given the opportunity to provide feedback on their experience of the service. Where possible, we would greatly encourage students to do so to inform the development of the service.

Important: The extenuating circumstances policy and procedure will not differ between students studying on programmes participating in the pilot and those who are not, the university is simply trialling a new service for submitting declarations.

17.2 Academic Integrity

Please refer to the following guidance:

Cardiff University Academic Integrity Policy.

Please complete the Academic Integrity Policy module on [Learning Central](#)

[Artificial Intelligence \(AI\) in your Learning – A guide for students - Student intranet - Cardiff University](#)



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Cardiff University recommends that students use the Harvard referencing format when writing coursework for all modules. Further information and guidance on the referencing and the citation style that you should use can be found at [here](#).